

Brainstorming – Idea Generation & Prioritization

Project: Employee Software Installation Request (ServiceNow)

1. Background

Employees often require licensed software such as Microsoft Office, Adobe Photoshop, AutoCAD, and other business applications on their work devices. In many organizations, these requests are submitted through emails or verbal communication with the IT department. This manual process creates several challenges, including delayed responses, misplaced requests, lack of visibility into software license availability, and inconsistent approval from reporting managers.

To address these issues, the project aims to automate the complete software installation request process using the ServiceNow platform.

2. Brainstorming Session Goal

The objective of the brainstorming session was to identify and evaluate different approaches for digitizing the software installation request process. The proposed solution should automate the complete lifecycle of a request—from employee submission and manager approval to IT fulfillment—while improving transparency, efficiency, and accountability.

3. Ideas Generated

Idea 1: Email-Based Request Tracking

Employees continue sending software requests through email, while the IT team records them in a shared Excel spreadsheet or SharePoint tracker.

Advantages

- Easy to implement
- Requires minimal changes to the existing process

Limitations

- Manual tracking
- High possibility of missed or duplicate requests
- No automated approval or workflow

Idea 2: Generic Helpdesk Ticket

Every software installation request is logged as a standard IT helpdesk ticket without a dedicated workflow.

Advantages

- Requests are centrally recorded
- IT team can monitor ticket status

Limitations

- No structured request form
- Manager approval must be handled manually
- Difficult to collect software-specific information

Idea 3: ServiceNow Service Catalog Item (Selected)

Create a dedicated Service Catalog item where employees submit software installation requests by providing details such as software name, version, business justification, device information, license type, and required installation date. The request automatically follows an approval workflow before reaching the IT team.

Advantages

- Standardized request process
- Automatic manager approval
- Easy tracking of request status
- Native ServiceNow implementation
- Reduced manual effort

Idea 4: Chatbot-Based Request

Allow employees to request software using a chatbot integrated with ServiceNow, which creates the request automatically.

Advantages

- User-friendly experience
- Faster request submission

Limitations

- Requires chatbot integration
- Higher implementation effort

- Better suited as a future enhancement

Idea 5: Self-Service Software Portal with License Tracking

Develop a comprehensive self-service portal that includes software requests, automatic approval, license availability verification, and incident creation when licenses are unavailable.

Advantages

- Complete end-to-end automation
- Real-time license monitoring
- Improved asset management

Limitations

- High implementation complexity
- Requires integration with software license management

4. Prioritization (Impact vs. Effort)

Idea	Business Impact	Implementation Effort	Decision
Email + Shared Tracker	Low	Low	Not Selected
Generic Helpdesk Ticket	Medium	Low	Not Selected
ServiceNow Service Catalog with Approval Workflow	High	Medium	Selected
Chatbot-Based Request	Medium	High	Future Enhancement
Self-Service Portal with License Tracking	High	High	Phase 2 Enhancement

5. Selected Approach

The selected solution is to develop a **ServiceNow Service Catalog Item** for software installation requests.

The workflow is designed as follows:

Employee Request → Service Catalog Item → Requested Item (RITM) → Manager Approval → IT Fulfillment Task → Software Installation

If the requested software license is unavailable, the system automatically creates an **Incident** for the IT Asset or License Management team to investigate and resolve the issue.

This approach provides a structured, automated, and easily traceable request lifecycle while making full use of ServiceNow's built-in capabilities.

6. Reason for Selecting This Approach

The ServiceNow Service Catalog approach was selected because it provides the best balance between business value and implementation effort.

Key reasons include:

- Uses ServiceNow's built-in Service Catalog, Approval Engine, and Task Management features without requiring external tools.
- Provides employees with a simple and standardized request form.
- Automatically routes requests to the appropriate manager for approval.
- Generates fulfillment tasks for the IT team, ensuring every request is tracked until completion.
- Improves transparency by allowing employees, managers, and IT staff to monitor request status in real time.
- Reduces manual work, minimizes errors, and ensures a consistent approval process.
- Can be extended in future phases with features such as license availability checks, chatbot integration, automated notifications, and software asset management.

Overall, this solution offers a practical, scalable, and industry-standard implementation that can be completed within the project timeline while demonstrating a complete ServiceNow workflow.